



« “We were going through names and I realised that the perfect coach for me at this point would be someone who has been through the experiences I am going through, possibly a multiple Grand Slam winner, a former (world) number one.”

– Novak Djokovic on appointing Andy Murray as his coach »



« “I’m pleased to say that I take home a declaration of intent, a letter of application to join the bidding discussions for the 2028 Under-20 World Championships.”

– World Athletics head Sebastian Coe revealed after Athletics Federation of India submitted a letter of intent »

5th

Kenya’s Sebastian Sawe went fifth in the all-time list after winning the Valencia marathon in 2hr 2min 5secs on his debut in the event. Only compatriots Kelvin Kiptum and Eliud

Kipchoge, and the Ethiopian pair of Kenenisa Bekele and Sisay Lemma, have gone faster than Sawe, the world half-marathon champion in 2023. Ethiopia’s Megertu Alemu took almost two minutes off her personal best to claim the women’s title in 2hr 16min 49secs.



8000

A French court fined an Australian man who tried to disrupt the start of the men’s Olympic 100m final at the Paris Games the sum of 8,000 euros (\$8,440). Judged in absentia, the 24-year-old Australian also received a three-year stadium ban from the court in Bobigny, north of Paris. Wearing a T-shirt emblazoned with “Free Palestine, Free Ukraine, Jesus,” the man was intercepted by security staff at the Stade de France as he tried to enter the track during the Games on August 4.

ATHLETES OF THE YEAR



Dutch marathon runner Sifan Hassan (right) and Botswanan sprinter Letsile Tebogo (second from left), both of whom took gold at the Paris Olympics, were named ‘Athletes of the Year’ by World Athletics in Monaco. Hassan, who also won the out-of-stadium award, was rewarded for her incredible performance in the French capital, which stretched beyond the marathon and on to the track. In the space of seven days, she won two bronze medals in the 5,000 metres, having also run a heat, and the 10,000m, and a spectacular gold in the marathon when she outsprinted Ethiopia’s then world record holder, Tigist Assefa, to win by just three seconds. Tebogo received his award after becoming the first African to be crowned Olympic champion in the 200m, crossing the line at the Stade de France in 19.46 seconds, edging out the American Kenny Bednarek and favourite Noah Lyles. AFP